

VER. 26.4

Rules

Duels

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1. Striking Zones (legal vs illegal)

1.1. Counted strike (legal strikes)

During the fights of each category, the **number of strikes** by the blade of the weapon delivered into the legal strike zone of the opponent's body is counted.

A counted strike is considered a strike if it was **clear and deliberate**, and the opponent failed to counter it effectively with a defensive action.

1.2. Prohibited Strike Zones (illegal strikes)

The following zones are "illegal strikes" and will not count for your score. Striking into these zones can result in penalties or disqualification.

1.2.1. Back and Front of the Neck

Strikes to the back and front of the neck are prohibited.

1.2.2. Base of Skull

The base of the skull is considered a prohibited strike zone, specifically defined as the bottom third of the back of the helmet.

1.2.3. Back of Knee

Strikes to the back of the knee are prohibited. No pressure is to be placed on the back of the knee.

1.2.4. Groin and Crotch

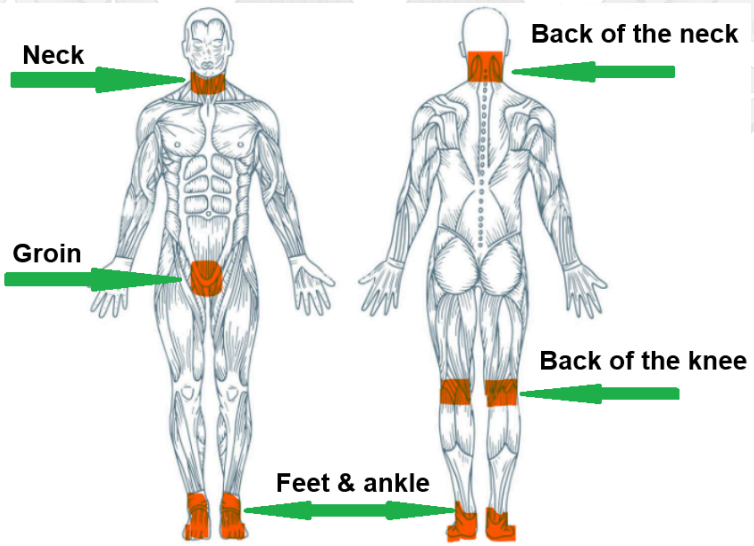
Strikes to the groin and crotch are prohibited.

1.2.5. Feet and Ankles

Strikes to the feet and ankles are prohibited. However, striking the foot is not considered a prohibited strike if the competitor raises their foot while the strike is already occurring.

1.2.6. Unprotected Body Parts

Any part of the opponent's body that has lost itself protection is considered a prohibited strike zone.



2. Scoring and Rounds

2.1. Scoring

2.1.1. Sword and Shield

Each strike to the legal striking zone of the opponent will score:

- **2 points**:
  - Head
  - Torso
- **1 point**:
  - Legs
  - Arms
  - Hands

2.1.2. Sword and Buckler

Each strike to the legal striking zone of the opponent will score:

- **1 point**

2.1.3. Polearm

The **full length of the cutting edge** of the weapon is considered a blade.

Offensive actions with the haft of the polearm do not score.

The grip must be **held with 2 hands** for a strike to be counted.

Each strike to the legal striking zone of the opponent will score:

- **0 point**:
  - Hands
- **1 point**:
  - All other legal striking zones

2.1.4. Longsword

Each strike to the legal striking zone of the opponent will score:

2 hands holding the grip:

- **2 points**:
  - Head
  - Torso
- **1 point**:
  - Arms
  - Legs
  - Hands

1 hand holding the grip:

- **1 point**:
  - All legal striking zones

2.2. Rounds, Matches and Winning Conditions

2.2.1. Sword and Buckler

A **match** is won by the first competitor who has **2 round victories**.

A **round** is won by the competitor who has either:

- scored **5 points** first before the time limit, or
- scored **more points** than their opponent if the time limit has been reached.

The maximum score for a round is 5 points.

The maximum time limit for a round is **1 minute**.

There is **no break** in between rounds.

2.2.2. Polearm, Longsword and Sword and Shield

A **match** is won by the competitor who has **scored at least 2 more points** than their opponent during the overall match.

The score of the match is the sum of the scores of the rounds.

A match consists of **2 main rounds of 1 minute** each.

If the score difference between the 2 competitors is less than 2 points after the 2 main rounds, **additional 30-second rounds** are fought until the 2-point difference is reached.

There is a **30-second break** in between rounds.

Important!

The organizers can change the length of the round, provided this decision is coordinated with the Head Organization and is registered in the Tournament Regulations.

2.3. Technical win

A “technical win” is awarded to one of the competitors in the following cases:

2.3.1. Withdrawal

A competitor is considered as withdrawn is they either:

- Failed to **report to the list** upon the Head Referee’s call.
- Failed to **prepare the equipment** within the designated time.
- **Withdraws** before the match has started.

The competitor who failed to report to the list for the match may be penalized by a yellow card.

In the case a competitor cannot participate in the competition because of an injury or disqualification, their opponent is awarded a technical win.

2.3.2. Injury

If the competitor cannot continue the match due to the injury caused by an illegal strike, their opponent receives a penalty of a red card and is banned from further participation in the tournament.

The severity of the injury must be assessed by the designated medics of the tournament.

The injured competitor is awarded a technical win.

The injured competitor is withdrawn from further matches in this category.

2.3.3. Disqualification of the opponent

If a competitor gets **2 yellow cards or 1 red card**, all their following opponents are awarded a technical win.

2.3.4. Armor failure

If the match is impeded due to equipment failure that is impossible to fix within the designated time frame of **1 minute**.

Scoring for “technical win”
5-0 for 2 rounds for Sword and Buckler category

10-0 per round for all other categories

3. Authorized Fighting Techniques

These rules aim to define a set of permitted and prohibited actions to ensure the safety of participants while engaging in combat.

The guidelines cover striking, grabbing, and various techniques to maintain a fair and controlled environment during the event.

3.1. Permitted Strikes

Strikes with the **blade and the haft** of the weapon are permitted.

Buckler: Strikes with the **flat of the buckler** are permitted.

Polearm: Strikes with a **free hand**, if they have a weapon in the other hand, are permitted.

3.2. Strike Zones

Strikes to **any area not mentioned as a prohibited strike zone** are permitted.

3.3. Parry

Parrying the opponent's strikes is permitted.

3.4. Techniques and moves with shields (Buckler, Sword and Shield)

Pushing the opponent with the **shoulder or the flat of the shield** is permitted.

Pushing the blade, shield, armed hand or upper body (above the waistline) of the opponent with the **flat or edge of the shield** is permitted.

Using the **shield to hook or cover** the opponent's shield is permitted.

3.5. Techniques and moves (Longsword, Polearm)

Pushing the opponent with the **blade or arms** is permitted.

Pushing off the opponent's arms with the **arms** is permitted.

3.6. Weapon-Grabbing

Participants are allowed to grab their own weapon (**except the blade**) with their hands.

3.7. Pinned to the List Rail

Pinning an opponent to the list is not against the rules; however, if a competitor is pinned against the list rail, the Knight Marshal will call '**Break Fight**' and reset the competitors to the center of the list.

4. Prohibited Fighting Techniques

These rules aim to ensure the safety, fairness, and adherence to a set of standards.

4.1. Unlisted Techniques

Any actions not listed in section 3 (Authorized Fighting Techniques) of the rules are prohibited.

4.2. Thrusting Actions

Any **thrusting action** with a weapon is prohibited.
Threats of a thrusting action are prohibited.

4.3. Offensive Actions on Prohibited Strike Zones

Any offensive action landing on any **prohibited strike zone** is prohibited.

4.4. Striking to Grounded or Rising Competitors

Striking a **grounded or rising** competitor is prohibited.

4.5. Strikes to Disarmed Opponent

Strikes to an opponent who has **lost their weapon** are prohibited.

4.6. Strikes with the Head

Strikes to an opponent **with the head** are prohibited.

4.7. Strikes with Legs

Strikes with **feet, shin, and knees** are prohibited.

4.8. Techniques and Moves

Back heels, wrestling throws, and clinching are prohibited.

4.9. Strikes with Hands and Elbows

Strikes with **hands and elbows** are prohibited, with the exception of the Polearm category.
See “3.1. Permitted Strikes” for details.

4.10. Strikes with the pommel or cross guard of a Bladed Weapon

Strikes delivered with the **pommel or cross guard** of a bladed weapon are prohibited.

4.11. Grappling

Grappling with hands and arms to the opponent’s torso, head, and limbs.
Handholds of the opponent’s sword.
Trap opponents' weapons by shield, buckler and/or arm/hands.

4.12. Strikes with a Shield

Strikes delivered with the **edge of a shield** are prohibited.

4.13. Strikes with a Buckler

Strikes with the edge of **a buckler** are prohibited.

5. Authorized Equipment

These rules aim to ensure a high standard of authenticity, safety, and historical accuracy in the equipment and conduct of the participants.

Reference all Authenticity Committee documents for the detailed rules.

5.1. Technical and Authentic Compliance

All equipment must meet Buhurt International technical and authentic requirements.

Reference:

- "**Armors and Weapons Aesthetics and Decorations"** document for the rules.
- "**Technical Requirements for Weapons**" document.
- "**Technical Requirements for Armors**" document.

5.2. Competitor Eligibility

Competitors are not allowed unless they have passed technical and authenticity checks.

5.3. Weapon Requirements

Reference "**Technical Requirements for Weapons**" document for all the rules.

Reference "**Weapons/Shield Chart"** document for sizes and weights.

Reminder: Low-quality, dirty, rusty, or historically implausible weapons are not allowed.

5.4. Footwear

Reference "**Textiles and Leather**" document for details.

Reminder: Only medieval Shoes with low profile (non-lugged/studded/spiked) are allowed.

5.5. Materials

Reference "**Textiles and Leather**" document for details.

Reminder: Modern adhesive tape, plastic ties, and other visible modern materials are not permitted.

Textile adhesive tape of neutral colors for kit repair is an exception.

5.6. Decorations

Reference "**Armors and Weapons Aesthetics and Decorations"** for details.

Reminder: Slogans and imagery on equipment should be historically plausible and not derogatory.

No modern equipment or decorations are allowed.

5.7. Equipment Changes

Participants are allowed to change elements of equipment (armor or weapon) during intervals or due to breakage.

Technical Marshal supervision is required for equipment changes.

6. Management of the competitors

Management of the competitors is conducted in accordance with the Buhurt International Duels Regulations, with penalties that are imposed depending on the situation in the list and competitors' and marshals' actions.

7. Changelog

This will be the change log of this document. It will be updated regularly and will display what has been removed/added/reworded/formatted. This way BI keeps transparent communication and clarity about the rules.

April - 2026 (V. 26.4)

Formatting redone for consistency and readability. Except points listed below, no content changes.
Grammatical corrections were also made.

Clarification:

- Titles for 1.3.1. “Cases For Grounding” and 1.3.2. “Cases for Not Grounding”. No content changes except:
  - “While not carrying a weapon in your hand you're not allowed to engage in offensive actions [...]” to “While not carrying a weapon in their hand, they engaged in offensive actions [...]”
  - “Any part of a polearm, a sword blade or mace is not considered as contacting the ground.” yo “They touched the ground with any part of a weapon”.

Add:

- 3.”Authorized Equipement”: Multiple references to AC documents for details.
- 4.3. Weapon-Grabbing: “Grabbing your own blade by the hand is not allowed.”
- 4.5. Weapon Loss: “Grab a weapon left on the table top by an active fighter.”

Clarification:

- 6.4.2. No “wide” top bar list
- 4. Authorized Fighting Techniques: Introduction paragraph moved to 4.5. Weapon Loss section.

Add:

- 2.3.2. Injury: “The severity of the injury must be assessed by the designated medics of the tournament.”

Clarification:

- 2.3. Technical win: scores are per round
- 4.3. Offensive Actions on Prohibited Strike Zones: “Any offensive action landing on any prohibited strike zone is prohibited.”
- Split of 4.9. Punches and elbow strikes in: 4.9.Strikes with Hands and Elbows and 4.13.

Suppression:

- 5.1. General Requirements: title has been removed for uselessness. Subsequent titles have been moved up.

Add:

- 5. ”Authorized Equipement”: Multiple references to AC documents for details.

Update: January 2026

-add: 2.2.1 In case of a draw, fight additional rounds until one competitors has two round victories

-add: 4.11 Trap opponents' weapons by shield, buckler and/or arm/hands.

-add: 5.1.4 Medieval Shoes with low profile (non lugged/studded/spiked) soles as referenced in Authenticity Standards.

Update: october 2025

- add: 1.2.

Update: March 2025

-add: 3.7 Pinned to the List Rail

To see older changelogs, please refer to the archived documents.